



Widescreen resolutions allow better use of workspace

you rotate the screen to a vertical layout. This is really useful when you're browsing.

Widescreens are perfect for HD media and even standard DVD resolutions. When these videos are played on standard 4:3 screens as on almost all CRTs, you find a thick black band at the top and bottom—wasted space. On a widescreen LCD monitor, you're rid of these blank spaces, and the movie fits your screen perfectly (or close to perfect, depending on the media).

DVI Or VGA?

DVI (Digital Video Interface) is what you should be using with your LCD monitor—not your old VGA cable. DVI gives better quality compared to the VGA. Before buying an LCD, you need to make sure your graphics card has a DVI connector, and at the same time, make sure the LCD has it too. Most LCDs today come with both VGA and DVI connectors, but you might come across some that only have VGA connectors—to save on costs. VGA cables carry analogue signals that are converted by the graphics card. DVI is a digital solution and needs no conversion. Also, faulty VGA cables would result in degradation of quality.

Resolutions And More

It's common to find groups of monitors supporting the same resolution.

For example, 17-inch and 19-inch widescreens usually have a resolution of 1440 x 900, and 20-inch and 22-inch widescreens have a resolution of 1680 x 1050. Larger screens don't always mean higher resolutions, so you need to find the perfect balance between size

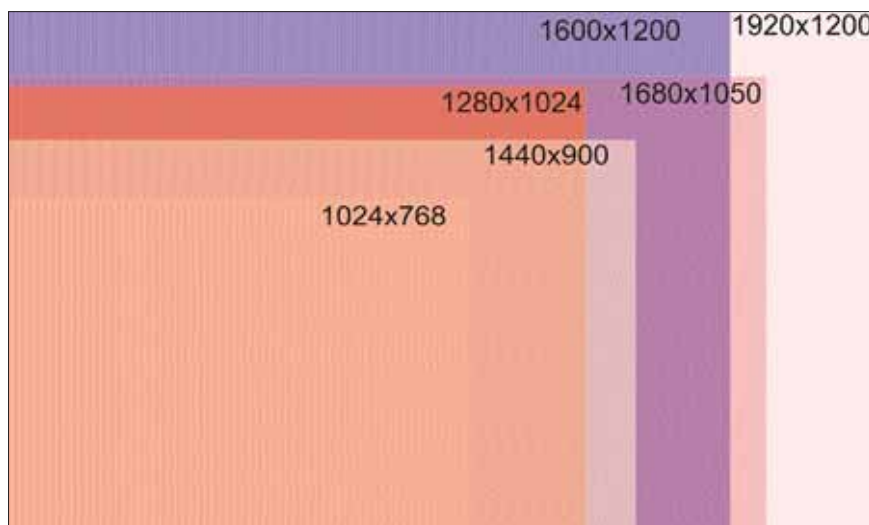
and resolution and see if it's worth the extra price you pay for a larger monitor.

There's no doubt that bigger areas on screen, no matter what the resolu-

tion will display, comparatively, some increase in text size. You might therefore want to increase the distance. But always remember, never sit with your face too close to a screen—it can cause damage to the eyes.

It's the same case with large LCD or plasma screens which you would use as a television—a huge screen doesn't always mean high resolution. It's best again to keep it a distance that takes into account the size of your screen. Remember that sitting too close to the screen, in case of large widescreens of sizes such as 24-inch and higher, means you wouldn't be able to comfortably view the entire screen with a gap of 1 to 2 feet.

Resolutions, too, are a factor while talking of viewing distance. For example, low-resolution videos up-scaled to a screen won't be suitable for closer viewing. As much as possible, it's advisable to play high-definition media if you



A visual comparison of commonly used resolutions

tion, are always fun for movies and games, but when you buy a large screen for general Desktop use, you might have to place the monitor a little away from yourself. For example, if you currently have a 20-inch screen and sit 2 feet away from it, a 22-inch screen of the same res-

want to sit really close to the screen.

To give you a clearer idea of how much difference in workspace there is between resolutions, here's a graphical representation to help you relate with your current monitor resolution. ☒

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